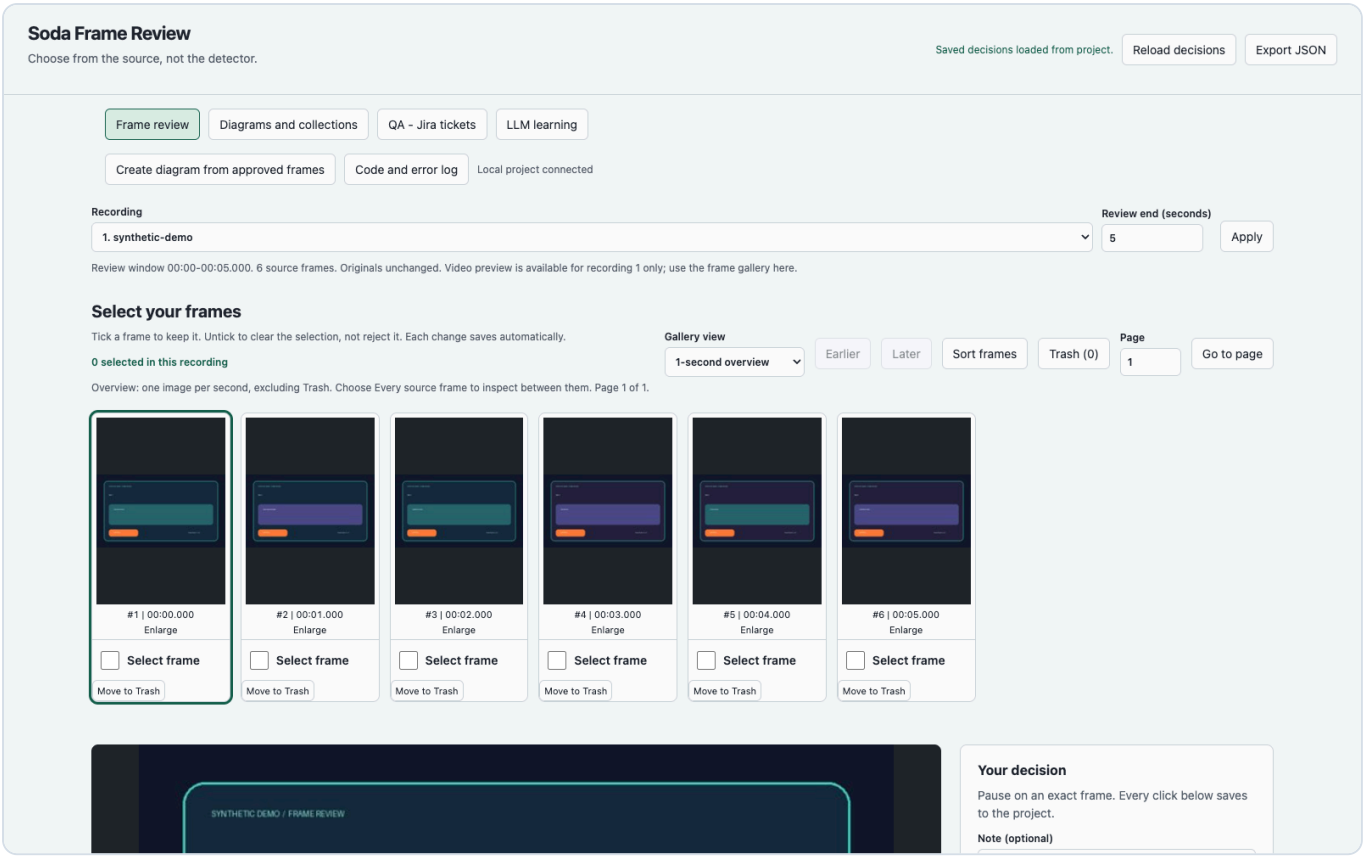
ILLUSTRATED QUICK START

Soda Frame Review

Review a video timeline frame by frame. Keep the exact visual states that matter, record your own decisions, and build a chronological reference diagram.



Dashboard overview. The frames shown here are synthetic examples created only to illustrate the interface.

What you need

A local frame archive and its manifest, plus the project's saved decision dataset. The app reads source frames; it does not edit the original media.

Start the local dashboard

```
SODA_FRAME_ARCHIVE="/path/to/soda-video-frames" \
/opt/local/bin/python3 tools/soda-frame-review/server.py --port 8767
```

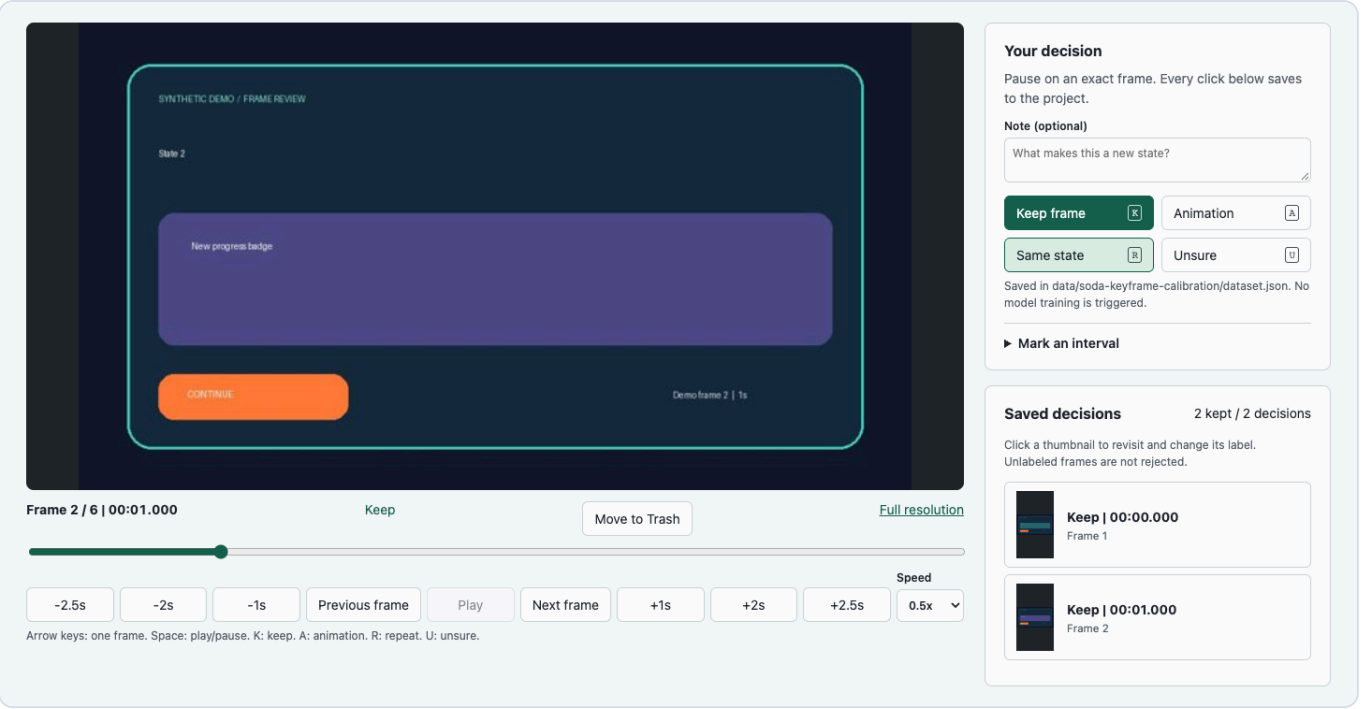
Then open `http://127.0.0.1:8767/`. Use the Python environment that has Pillow installed.

> **Private by default:** the dashboard is a local tool. Do not publish source videos, frame archives, saved labels, drafts or workspace data with the tutorial.

01 · INSPECT AND DECIDE

Review the exact frame

Choose a recording, then use the gallery to find a moment. The one-second overview is a quick scan; choose **Every source frame** when you need to inspect frames between overview samples.



Viewer and decision panel. The example shows two saved decisions on synthetic frames.

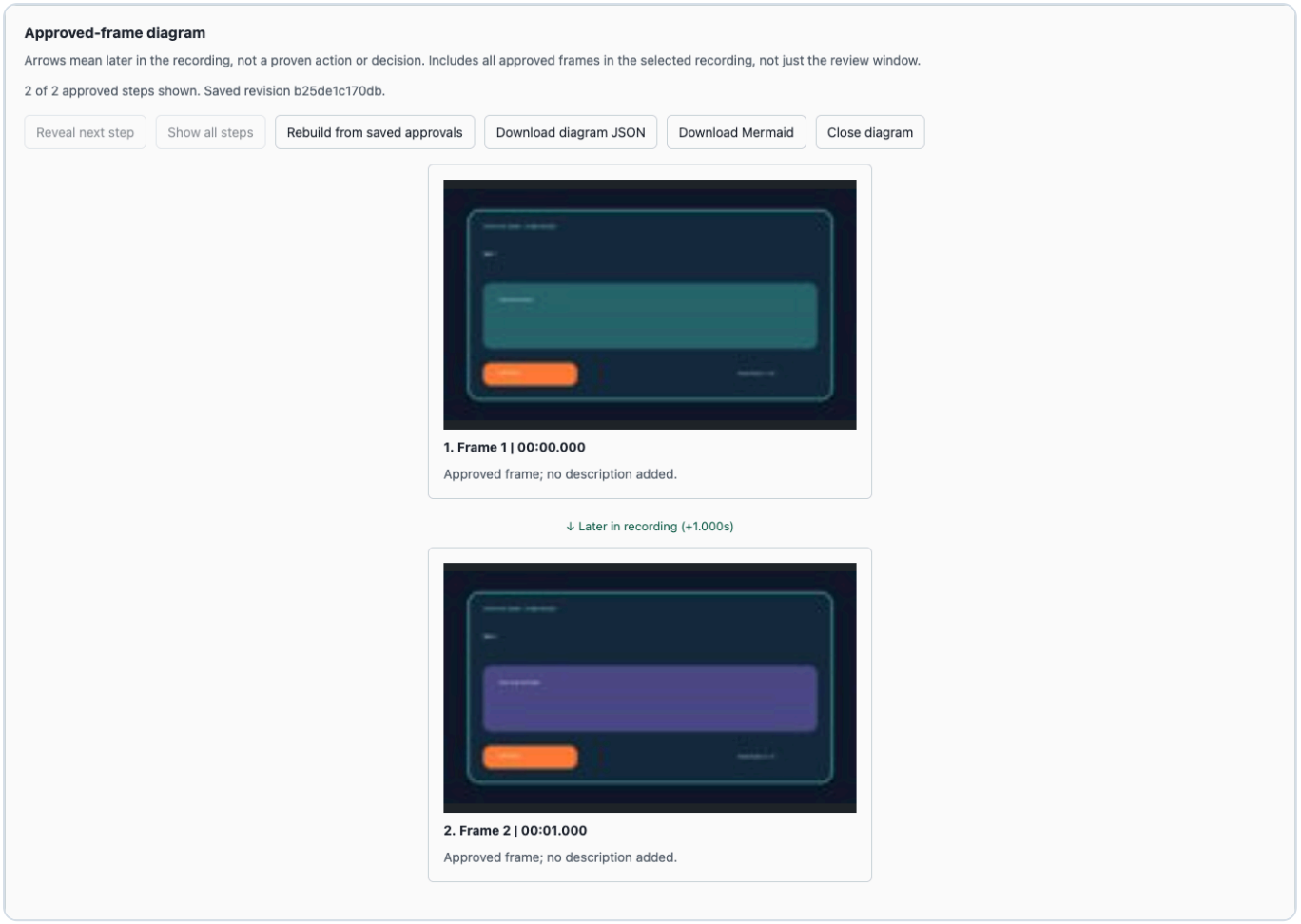
1. Select a frame in the gallery, or use **Previous frame**, **Next frame**, the timeline, or the time-jump buttons to inspect the source sequence.
2. Pause on the exact image you want to classify. Review visible text, controls, counters and other meaningful changes.
3. Choose **Keep frame**, **Animation**, **Same state** or **Unsure**. Decisions save to the local dataset automatically.
4. Use **Reload decisions** if another window changed the dataset. A stale write is refused rather than silently overwriting newer decisions.

> **Keyboard shortcuts:** K Keep · A Animation · R Same state · U Unsure · arrow keys move one frame · Space toggles playback when a preview is available.

02 · BUILD A REFERENCE

Create the approved-frame diagram

The diagram is a read-only chronological view of saved **Keep frame** decisions for the selected recording.



Example diagram with all approved synthetic demo steps revealed.

1. Return to **Frame review** and select **Create diagram from approved frames**.
2. Choose **Reveal next step** to inspect one item at a time, or **Show all steps** for the full sequence.
3. Click a diagram item to inspect its exact frame. Rebuild the diagram after saved decisions change.
4. Use the JSON or Mermaid export only if you need a separate reference file.

> **Interpret carefully:** arrows mean “later in this recording.” They do not prove an action, decision, branch or causal link. Similar-looking frames are not automatically discarded.

Keep these boundaries

- Unlabeled frames are not rejected. A Keep decision is a human review choice, not a model-training event.
- Trash changes dashboard visibility; it does not delete source frames.
- Review personal or confidential content before sharing screenshots or exports. The screenshots in this guide contain synthetic examples, not research footage.